

Christos Hadjinikolis

ML Tech Lead (Staff-Level) @ Vortexa Ltd | Ph.D.

Committee Expert Member @ JTC'21

✉ christos.hadjinikolis@gmail.com

mediums

🌐 personal website

 LinkedIn

 github

 Google Scholar

 YouTube

languages

bilingual Greek/English

programming

Java, Python, SQL, Cypher

author

pypi:dynamicio

developer skills

distributed ML systems,
CI/CD, IaC, observability,
model/data versioning,
production monitoring

cloud-platforms

AWS, GCP

technologies & frameworks

PyTorch-distributed,
Transformers, py/Spark,
py/Flink, Kafka, FastApi,
Docker, MLflow, Kubeflow,
Airflow, Elasticsearch

python libs

pandas, numpy, pytorch

visualisations

Gephi, Seaborn,
plotly/streamlit

interests

Sports: Tennis, Jogging,

Reading: Comics, Philosophy,
Politics

about me

Staff-level ML systems engineer with 15+ years of experience designing and operating production AI systems across data platforms, backend engineering, and platform delivery. Recent work has focused on transformer-based forecasting, real-time inference pipelines, streaming data infrastructure, and the operational discipline required to move models from experimentation into reliable production. Strong record of owning ambiguous, high-scale problems end-to-end, partnering closely with scientists and engineers, and building observable, maintainable systems around heterogeneous data and GPU-backed ML workloads.

work-experience

since 12/2020 **Vortexa Ltd, London, UK**

ML Tech Lead (Staff-Level) | Pod Lead

Lead the design and delivery of large-scale ML systems for maritime forecasting, combining transformer-based modelling, streaming infrastructure, backend services, and production rollout discipline. Own technical direction across cross-functional teams and drive the conversion of advanced modelling work into reliable, user-facing systems with measurable operating quality.

- **Data Platform Foundations:** Built distributed Flink and pandas workflows over geospatial, textual, and graph-structured datasets, improving throughput by 25% and strengthening ingestion foundations for downstream training and inference.
- **Production Inference Systems:** Delivered backend model-serving services with versioning, switch-over logic, auditability, and operational safeguards for continuously running prediction systems.
- **Model Lifecycle Engineering:** Built training and inference workflows with CI/CD, GPU support, online evaluation, and traceable performance monitoring to support dependable deployment over time.
- **Streaming Infrastructure:** Designed Kafka-based pipelines supporting near real-time model refresh and downstream triggers across 15+ ETL components.
- **Staff-Level Ownership:** Led delivery across ML, DS, and DE functions, set engineering standards, and raised execution quality for systems moving from research-grade ideas to production behaviour.

2016–2020 **DataReply, London, UK**

Data Scientist | ML Engineer

Progressed from Data Scientist to ML Engineer, leading cross-functional DS/DE teams and delivering production-grade systems across UBS, Vodafone, and CNHi. Work centered on platformisation, observability, deployment workflows, and turning data-science prototypes into maintainable software systems.

- **Vodafone Group (09/2019–11/2020, London):**
 - Co-led Vodafone's internal MLOps platform (**Infinity Project**) on GCP using **Kubeflow**, supporting model versioning, deployment, telemetry, and resource-governed notebooks.
 - Implemented CI/CD pipelines, shared feature and data workflows, and monitoring for reproducible, production-ready ML systems.
- **CNHi (05/2019–09/2019, Chicago):**
 - Built **time-series forecasting** models over connected-vehicle telemetry and helped transition statistical prototypes into scalable, cloud-ready services.
- **UBS (08/2017–04/2019, London):**
 - Designed real-time pipelines using **graph analytics** and **process mining** to surface organisational insights and support decision automation.
 - Developed observability tooling with **Kafka**, **Elasticsearch**, and Python, connecting data infrastructure to downstream analytics and business-facing use cases.

2010–2016 **Roles in UK Institutions**

Assoc. Lect. @GSM | Coding Teacher @DGC | TA @KCL|UCL

Taught a broad range of computing subjects during doctoral studies, covering both undergraduate and pre-university curricula. The through-line from this period is deep technical communication, strong fundamentals, and the ability to make complex ideas operational for others.

- **2012–2016:** Lectured in Computing, MATLAB, Java, Python, HTML, CSS at GSM and David Game College
- **2010–2014:** TA at King's College London (KCL) and UCL, covering Java, Data Structures, Systems Architecture, Semantic Web, SQL, and AI.

education

- 2010–2014 **Ph.D. in Computer Science** King's College London, UK
Thesis: Persuasion Dialogues & Opponent Modelling.
Developed logical inference methods for large **Knowledge Graphs**, combining symbolic reasoning, **graph analytics**, and Bayesian techniques (e.g., MCMC). Research contributed to scalable AI systems grounded in formal semantics. Received **Best Poster Award** at IJCAI 2013 (413 submissions). Awarded **EPSRC PhD Scholarship**, **Outstanding TA Award** (student-nominated), and earned the **Graduate Certificate in Academic Practice**.
[Access Publications on Google Scholar](#)
- 2004–2010 **Diploma (BEng) in Computer Engineering** University of Thessaly, GR
Five-year polytechnic degree in Computer Science and Engineering with a **strong focus on mathematics** (10 courses), covering theoretical aspects, networking, and telecommunications. *Majored in Artificial Intelligence.*
- 2002–2004 **Military Officer: Second Lieutenant** National Guard, CY
Obligatory army service; position acquired through **competitive IQ** and athletic exams.

committees/affiliations

- since 10/2024 **University College London, Dept. of Information Studies** Associate Researcher
Support AI application, standardisation, and ethics initiatives in industry and academia.
- since 01/2021 **ISO - International Organisation for Standardisation** Committee Expert Member for JTC'21
Member of JTC'21 Working Group 3, developing AI standards aligned with EU policies and international norms.

talks/interviews

- 2023 **Bill Raymonds, Agile in Action** Podcast Interview
Agile Data Science: Sailing Through Data Science: The Agile Journey at Vortexa, [Details: YouTube](#)
- 2022 **Open Data Science Conference** Industry Conference Talk
Dynamicio, a python library for abstracting your I/O, [Details: here](#)
- 2020 **iunera: Big Data Innovators** Interview Blog Post
The Agile approach in data science explained by an ML expert, [Details: here](#)
- 2020 **Big Data Warsaw** Industry Conference Talk
Monitoring and Analysing Communication and Trade Events as Graphs, [Details: here](#)
- 2018 **Connected Data London** Panelist @ Industry Conference
AI tribes and interconnections: what's graph got to do with it?, [Details: here](#)
- 2018 **Minds Mastering Machines** Industry Conference Talk
A talk on doing Data Science the Agile Way, [Details: here](#)

certificates & awards

- 07/2020 **AWS Certified Machine Learning - Specialty** AWS
Validation Number: D0R0WC7CN1VQ13SV
- 01/2019 **Process Mining** Coursera Course Certificates
License number: AFU2VTP6273V
- 10/2017 **Google Certified Professional - Data Engineer** Google Cloud Certified
Credential ID: 000000400
- 07/2017 **Advanced Elasticsearch: Data modelling** Elastic
Enrolment Id: 33442
- 06/2016 **Graph Analytics for Big Data** Coursera Course Certificates
License number: NZADYAQ7N8FW
- 05/2016 **Apache Spark Developer Certification** O'Reilly Media
License number: 1.x-0548
- 04/2016 **Neo4j Certified Professional** Neo Technology, Creators of Neo4j
License number: here